Ahmed Sajid Butt

SOC Analyst L1 / Security Analyst

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SUMMARY

Computer Science graduate with hands-on experience in threat detection and SOC workflows using Microsoft Defender XDR, Microsoft Sentinel, KQL, and the ELK Stack, skilled in endpoint security administration, adversary simulation with Atomic Red Team, and building custom SIEM detections mapped to MITRE ATT&CK. Former OWASP BULC Chapter Lead and published IEEE coauthor, seeking an entry-level SOC, security analyst, or detection engineering role to grow these skills in a live environment.

EXPERIENCE

Threat Detection & SOC Research Intern (Cybersecurity Intern) | CNS Engineering, Lahore Jan 2026 - Jun 2026

- Conducted hands-on Microsoft Defender XDR research in a self-built M365 E5 lab, covering endpoint detection, threat simulation, and incident investigation workflows.
- Investigated a high-severity incident correlating 14 alerts and 13 pieces of forensic evidence, cross-referencing file hashes against VirusTotal to trace the attack chain to root cause.
- Ran a ransomware attack simulation and executed 7 MITRE ATT&CK techniques from Kali Linux via Atomic Red Team, confirming Defender blocked 3 outright (incl. Mimikatz credential dumping) while detecting 3 others (e.g., scheduled task persistence) behaviorally, then traced the incident end-to-end in Defender XDR to assess detection and alerting gaps.
- Wrote 3 KQL queries in Advanced Hunting across a 2-hour telemetry window, surfacing 5 findings mapped to 6 MITRE ATT&CK techniques.
- Documented Defender's Automated Investigation & Response (AIR) during a Priority 100 incident with 6 correlated alerts, including automatic account containment and evidence collection.
- Simulated phishing via Attack Simulation Training (20% credential compromise rate, credential entry in under 2 minutes) and authored a 6-phase Phishing Response Playbook aligned to NIST SP 800-61, mapping actions to 7 MITRE ATT&CK techniques.
- Onboarded 4 endpoints to Microsoft Defender for Endpoint via GPO and Microsoft Intune, troubleshooting and resolving silent onboarding failures and EDR policy conflicts.
- Authored formal SOC deliverables (Threat Hunt Report, Ransomware Incident Forensics Report) translating technical findings into actionable documentation.

EDUCATION

BS Computer Science | Bahria University, Lahore Oct 2021 - Jul 2025

PROJECTS

Vigil: SOC Detection Lab and Incident Response Jul 2026 - Aug 2026

- Built a SOC detection lab simulating a four-stage web application compromise (initial access through destructive impact) and deployed a full SIEM stack from scratch (Wazuh + OpenSearch on Docker), closing a log gap via an Nginx reverse proxy for web-layer logging.
- Wrote custom Wazuh detection rules using signature matching and frequency-based behavioral correlation, mapping each technique to MITRE ATT&CK (T1190, T1059.007, T1213, T1486).
- Integrated Wazuh with TheHive for automated alert-to-case escalation and ran the full analyst workflow (detection, triage, investigation, case closure); documented the build in a public GitHub portfolio repo with a complete evidence trail.

Sentinel Forge: SOC Home Lab, SIEM Deployment and Incident Triage Oct 2025 - Nov 2025

- Built a cloud-based security lab on Vultr using the ELK Stack for centralized log collection and analysis, with Sysmon deployed on Windows endpoints for system and network telemetry.
- Created custom Kibana detection rules (e.g., brute-force attacks), simulated adversary activity with Mythic C2 to validate detection coverage, and integrated Kibana alerts with OS Ticket for automated incident ticket creation.

Federated Learning IDS for IoT Healthcare, Final Year Project (Team Lead) Jun 2024 - May 2025

- Led a team to design a CNN, BiLSTM, and GRU-based intrusion detection model for IoT-enabled healthcare systems, achieving 99.8% detection accuracy and an overall Grade A evaluation; coauthored “Leveraging AI for Real-Time Intrusion Detection in IoT-Enabled Healthcare Systems,” published in IEEE Xplore, with a virtual oral presentation at the DataSciMI 2026 conference hosted at Bahria University.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Microsoft Defender XDR | Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) | Endpoint Security Administration | Microsoft Sentinel (SIEM) | Kusto Query Language (KQL) | Wazuh SIEM | TheHive Case Management | ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana) | OpenSearch | Sysmon | Log Analysis | Incident Triage | Threat Hunting | Active Directory | Microsoft Intune | Docker | Mythic C2 | Linux (Ubuntu, Kali Linux) | Windows Server | Troubleshooting

CERTIFICATIONS, TRAINING & LEADERSHIP

KC7 Security Analyst I (Mar 2026 - Apr 2026) & II (Apr 2026) | TryHackMe: Pre Security (Mar 2025 - Apr 2025), Cybersecurity 101 (Jul 2025 - Sep 2025) | ISO 27001 Associate, SkillFront (May 2024 - Jul 2024) | Google Cybersecurity, Coursera (Jun 2023 - Sep 2023)

OWASP BULC (Bahria University Lahore Campus), Chapter Lead, May 2024 - June 2025.